

Lady D KDP Trim and Cover Readiness Worksheet

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Purpose: prepare the next print-production phase for the three Lady D devotional volumes and their companion journals.

Current Assumptions

- Format target: Amazon KDP paperback, 6 x 9 in trim.
- Interior target: black ink paperback. White-paper and cream-paper spine calculations are both shown because the final paper choice is not locked yet.
- Interior review PDFs are current 6 x 9 review outputs for the devotionals and companion journals, not final KDP upload interiors. Page counts may change after final copyedit, author approval, proof corrections, and final export settings.
- Cover dimensions below use the official KDP paperback cover formula: bleed + back cover width + spine width + front cover width + bleed.
- For 6 x 9 covers with bleed, height is 9.25 in and width is 12.25 in plus spine width.
- All titles currently exceed 79 pages, so spine text is allowed, but it still needs KDP spine safe-area spacing.

Official KDP Sources Used

- [Create a Paperback Cover - Amazon KDP](#)
- [Set Trim Size, Bleed, and Margins - Amazon KDP](#)
- [Paperback Submission Guidelines - Amazon KDP](#)

KDP Formula Summary

- Cover width = 0.125 + back cover width + spine width + front cover width + 0.125.
- Cover height = 0.125 + trim height + 0.125.
- 6 x 9 full-wrap cover height with bleed: 9.25 in.
- 6 x 9 full-wrap cover width before spine: 12.25 in.
- Black-and-white white-paper spine width: page count x 0.002252 in.

- Black-and-white cream-paper spine width: page count x 0.0025 in.
- 6 x 9 interior page size without bleed: 6 x 9 in.
- 6 x 9 interior page size with bleed: 6.125 x 9.25 in.

Current Devotional Cover Size Matrix

- Volume 1 manuscript: 369 pages; white-paper spine 0.831 in; white-paper cover 13.081 x 9.250 in; cream-paper spine 0.923 in; cream-paper cover 13.173 x 9.250 in.
- Volume 2 manuscript: 369 pages; white-paper spine 0.831 in; white-paper cover 13.081 x 9.250 in; cream-paper spine 0.923 in; cream-paper cover 13.173 x 9.250 in.
- Volume 3 manuscript: 369 pages; white-paper spine 0.831 in; white-paper cover 13.081 x 9.250 in; cream-paper spine 0.923 in; cream-paper cover 13.173 x 9.250 in.

Current Companion Journal Cover Size Matrix

- Volume 1 journal: 470 pages; white-paper spine 1.058 in; white-paper cover 13.308 x 9.250 in; cream-paper spine 1.175 in; cream-paper cover 13.425 x 9.250 in.
- Volume 2 journal: 477 pages; white-paper spine 1.074 in; white-paper cover 13.324 x 9.250 in; cream-paper spine 1.193 in; cream-paper cover 13.443 x 9.250 in.
- Volume 3 journal: 483 pages; white-paper spine 1.088 in; white-paper cover 13.338 x 9.250 in; cream-paper spine 1.208 in; cream-paper cover 13.457 x 9.250 in.

Minimum Margin Matrix

- Volume 1 manuscript: 369 pages; 301-500 page band; inside/gutter minimum 0.625 in; outside no-bleed minimum 0.25 in; outside bleed minimum 0.375 in.
- Volume 2 manuscript: 369 pages; 301-500 page band; inside/gutter minimum 0.625 in; outside no-bleed minimum 0.25 in; outside bleed minimum 0.375 in.
- Volume 3 manuscript: 369 pages; 301-500 page band; inside/gutter minimum 0.625 in; outside no-bleed minimum 0.25 in; outside bleed minimum 0.375 in.

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Recommended Interior Path

1. Build final 6 x 9 interior templates for each manuscript and companion journal.
2. Use no-bleed interiors unless a later design pass intentionally adds edge-to-edge art.
3. Apply mirrored margins and the KDP minimum gutter by page-count band.
4. Add front matter, copyright, dedication, series page, author note, permissions note, and closing pages before locking page count.
5. Re-export final PDF interiors and rerun page-count extraction.
6. Recalculate full-wrap cover dimensions from the final page count and selected paper type.

Recommended Cover Path

1. Pick a visual route from the nine-cover board: Path, Modern Sacred Minimal, Sanctuary, or a hybrid route.
2. Decide paper type for each book: white paper for brighter covers and modern contrast, or cream paper for warmer devotional feel and slightly thicker spine.
3. Use the chosen final page count and paper type in the official KDP cover calculator before export.
4. Build a full-wrap PDF cover with back cover, spine, and front cover as one image/PDF.
5. Keep front/back text at least 0.125 in inside trim lines and keep spine text at least 0.0625 in from spine edges.
6. Avoid hard vertical color breaks at the spine because KDP allows binding/trim variance.
7. Export print cover art at 300 DPI, flattened, with fonts embedded or outlined in the production PDF.

Next Gate

The project is ready for a trim-specific KDP design pass, but not a final KDP upload yet. The final upload package should not be declared ready until each book has a locked paper type, final designed page count, print-ready interior PDF, print-ready full-wrap cover PDF, and fresh KDP previewer pass.